

Executive Summary

Tagline: Everything You Need. In One Place.

Summary

Swiftly is an all-in-one point of sale software that uses data collected at checkout to automate running a store. Sales data and trends are used for accounting, managing inventory, and restocking; customer history is used for personalized marketing; and employee activity drives productivity reports, among much more. The platform uses AI agents to process shipments, build schedules, run personalized marketing campaigns, and communicate with vendors — significantly reducing the human labor required to run a store. Swiftly replaces your POS, inventory, scheduling, accounting, and marketing tools, all in one subscription.

Problem Statement

Customer-facing businesses are using outdated and time-consuming practices to run their operations. 50% of business owners do accounting manually,¹ 43% of small businesses monitor their inventory manually,² and 38% of companies manually track employee attendance with paper timesheets.³ Existing POS software costs up to \$150/month, and proprietary hardware can cost up to \$900 — yet these solutions offer limited features that still require managers to do the majority of the work. The majority of store owners the founders spoke with pay for unnecessary software to handle accounting, scheduling, and marketing.

Solution

Swiftly's POS system is accessible on all devices, requiring no proprietary hardware. Swiftly integrates with all existing credit card terminals. The platform automates shipment processing by parsing vendor invoices directly into stock; if an error is found in an invoice, Swiftly will reach out to the vendor. It generates employee schedules intelligently based on availability,



maintains IRS-compliant accounting that updates with every transaction, uses AI to analyze sales trends to anticipate restock needs, builds custom email/SMS marketing campaigns based on new and slow-moving inventory, and provides employee performance reports.

Unlike competitors, Swftly seamlessly integrates with Shopify, DoorDash, Uber Eats, and payroll providers like ADP, Gusto, and Justworks. Swftly also integrates with Slack and WhatsApp so owners can easily communicate with Swftly to get reports on employee activity, stock, shipments, financial statements, and trends.

Market Opportunity

The U.S. POS software market was valued at \$4.7 billion in 2024 and is projected to reach \$9.8 billion by 2032.⁴ Small and medium enterprises account for 61% of that market and are expanding at 12.8% annually.⁵ In the United States, over 6 million small enterprises were using POS systems by the end of 2024, with adoption rising 17% compared to the previous year.⁶ Yet many still manage accounting manually, do not track inventory, and juggle multiple disconnected software subscriptions. Swftly targets this underserved base directly.

Every customer-facing business is a potential Swftly user. At \$35/month per store, we reach profitability at just five paying customers and are targeting 30 by end of year. Capturing just 1% of the U.S. POS market over a 5 to 7 year operational period represents 60,000 customers and \$25.2 million in annual recurring revenue.

Our beta case studies, beginning with Blooms by Marie in Albany, NY, and our 47-store waitlist provide early validation that customers are unsatisfied with their current POS system. We are cold-calling 50+ businesses per week, interviewing store owners to understand their pain points, and converting that pipeline directly into paying customers.

Competitive Advantage

Swftly operates in a market dominated primarily by Square and Toast. These platforms are expensive, lock store owners into proprietary hardware, and still demand significant manual



labor. Square charges up to \$149/month, plus hardware that can cost up to \$999, yet still requires manual shipment processing, inventory management, and accounting with limited reporting capabilities. Toast locks customers into proprietary hardware at \$69/month per terminal before add-ons. Neither platform automates inventory management, shipment processing, scheduling, accounting, or marketing — and both have limited integrations with Shopify, DoorDash, and Uber Eats, forcing store owners to manage those orders on separate devices entirely.

At \$35/month flat with no hardware requirements and no proprietary terminals, Swftly is the most affordable full-featured POS platform in the market. Stores currently spend hours each week manually processing incoming shipments. With Swftly, a business uploads a shipment invoice and the platform handles everything: the document is intelligently parsed, prices are updated, existing items are restocked, new products are created, invoice discrepancies are flagged, and vendors are contacted on the store's behalf to resolve them. Because all product and sales data flows through the POS, Swftly tracks expiring goods, identifies trends, and anticipates restocks before a store runs out. Swftly also uses sales data to identify slow-moving inventory and automatically plans marketing campaigns to promote it.

Swftly manages the store autonomously — communicating with vendors, running operations, and surfacing everything the owner needs through reports and alerts directly on their phone. Owners stay in control of executive decisions while Swftly handles everything else. Beyond agentic features, Swftly consolidates everything a store currently pays multiple providers for — POS, accounting, scheduling, and marketing — into one affordable plan.

Autonomous store management is inevitable. Our competitors will eventually build similar features. But engineering true agentic automation onto legacy architecture takes time, and their higher cost structures make it much harder to compete with our price point.

Business Model



Swiftly's business model is a \$35/month SaaS subscription. Infrastructure costs run at approximately \$170/month with 10 customers. Gross margin for 10 customers is approximately 51%, increasing to 61% at 1,000 customers. This model is profitable at five customers. We acquire customers through direct cold outreach, networking, social media advertising, and organic content creation.

Company Overview

When did you start?

The founding team, Daniel Budnyatsky and Daniel Lopez, started building Swiftly in early December 2025. Having just finished working at his fourth retail store in New York City, Daniel Lopez saw firsthand how outdated software was consuming hours of the workweek on tasks that could easily be automated. POS systems already collect all the data necessary at checkout: sales data for accounting, inventory trends for restocking, customer history for personalized marketing, employee activity for productivity reports, and much more. The founders built Swiftly to use that data to automate the tasks required to run a store. They are now continuing to develop the platform towards fully agentic workflows, where AI agents handle these operations autonomously and reduce the manual labor required from store staff entirely. AI agents handle the work themselves, doing a store's accounting, monitoring trends to find products that have been sitting for months, running a marketing campaign, generating schedules around employee availability and high traffic hours, and contacting vendors to restock before you run out.

What stage are you in?

Swiftly is in the late prototype/pre-revenue stage. The core POS platform is built and functional across desktop, web, and mobile. The team is currently backtesting and preparing for their initial case studies in mid April, while they continue to develop the agentic workflows that will



allow store operations to run autonomously and almost entirely replace labor needed to run store operations. The founders plan on launching the full software with agentic ability in July 2026.

What proof do you have that this is moving forward?

The team has secured their first case study partner with Blooms by Marie, a flower shop in Albany, NY, and are currently in conversations with five other businesses in Syracuse and New York City to join their initial case study cohort. Furthermore, the platform has a waitlist of 47 people. The team is actively cold calling 50+ businesses per week as part of ongoing market research and the response has been consistent. The majority of business owners the team speaks with resonate deeply with the problems Swftly is solving: they report paying for multiple disconnected software subscriptions, spending hours weekly on tasks Swftly can already automate, lacking any real marketing strategy or customer rewards system, and paying more monthly than Swftly's current pricing.

The founders have submitted grant proposals to Syracuse University's Orange Innovation Fund and a16z's Speedrun, and have been accepted into the Shopify Developer Program and AWS Developer Program, with an application to the DoorDash Developer Program in progress. A full product demo exists. Indaria Jones, Program Manager of the Couri Hatchery at the Whitman School of Business, has been advising the founders throughout the development of the platform.

Why are you uniquely positioned to build this?

Daniel Budnyatsky is studying accounting and worked at Licensed To Count Inc., an accounting firm that works with small businesses. Daniel Lopez has a technical background studying Computer Science at Stony Brook University and has experience working over 4 years at different retail and hospitality businesses across New York City with high level experience working with Swftly's competitor POS softwares. This is the team's second venture



together. The team first ran a successful residential window cleaning business that grew to 10 clients in 2 months from door to door sales and cold calling. Together, they bring experience from both sides of the industry. Four years working directly with competitor software exposed the team firsthand to the inefficiencies, gaps, and limitations that small business owners deal with every day, and informed every decision made in building Swftly. Combined with deep accounting expertise to properly architect and personalize complex financial features for each business type, and proven sales experience to build and grow a client base from the ground up, the team is uniquely positioned to build the product this market needs and put it in front of the people who need it most.

What is your long-term vision (5–10 years)?

The team's long-term vision is to make Swftly fully agentic, where AI agents have complete operational control of a store, reacting in real time to live data from every touchpoint. That means the POS, but also security cameras to monitor shoplifting and foot traffic, shelf placement analytics tied directly to sales performance, and continuous inventory and vendor coordination happening without human input. The goal is for Swftly to function as an autonomous manager that owners and employees interact with to set high-level goals and review performance, while agents execute the day-to-day operations. The team will leverage their growing network of real-world retail data to train proprietary models, creating an intelligence layer that is impossible for competitors to replicate. Beyond product development, the founders plan to scale the business by raising a pre-seed round to expand their engineering, customer support and marketing teams, solidifying Swftly as the standard for agentic retail operations.

Market Opportunity

How many customers experience this problem today?



There are over 33 million small businesses in the U.S. In the U.S. alone, over 70% of retail businesses use modern POS systems.⁹ Over 40% of those businesses are running POS software more than five years old,¹⁰ and most are still managing inventory, scheduling, accounting, and shipments manually or across disconnected tools. Small and medium enterprises represent 61% of the POS software market and are growing at a 12.8% CAGR.⁵ The team's ongoing store owner interviews confirm this directly. Existing Square and other POS customers are still paying separately for accounting and scheduling software or doing these tasks manually.

Market Sizing

TAM: All U.S. small businesses using POS software — approximately 5–8 million businesses.

SAM: Brick-and-mortar small businesses with 1–20 employees actively paying for 2+ disconnected tools — approximately 2 million businesses.

SOM (Year 1–2): Local and regional businesses reachable through direct outreach, referrals, and digital marketing — targeting 30–500 businesses in the first 18 months, scaling to 10,000 reachable businesses by Year 2.

The Math

1% SOM capture = 100 customers × \$35/month × 12 = \$42,000 ARR

500 customers = \$210,000 ARR

1,000 customers = \$420,000 ARR, still under 0.05% of SOM

What early adopter segment do we enter first?

The team will enter independent brick-and-mortar retail stores in New York State with 1–10 employees, currently using Square or managing operations manually across multiple tools.

What triggers someone to buy?



For new store owners, the trigger is Swftly's low price point and zero hardware restrictions: no locked-in terminals, no setup fees, just sign up and go. For existing store owners, the trigger is the accumulation of pain: hours lost to manual shipment processing, inventory management, scheduling, and accounting, combined with the frustration of paying premium rates across multiple disconnected software subscriptions. When the cost in time and money becomes undeniable, Swftly is the obvious switch.

What trend makes this opportunity grow over time?

AI adoption among small businesses is accelerating. 58% of small businesses now use generative AI, up from 40% in 2024 and more than double the adoption rate in 2023, according to the U.S. Chamber of Commerce,⁷ with 96% of small business owners planning to adopt emerging technologies including AI.⁸ At the same time, the cost of running a store is rising: labor costs, software subscriptions, and shrinking margins are forcing owners to find efficiencies. Swftly allows store owners to save on software with our affordable price and reduce the labor required to run store operations.

Solution

What does Swftly do?

Swftly brings all the services consumer stores use into one platform and automates them. Using data already collected by the POS — including transactions, employee activity, sales trends, and customer history — Swftly's agents handle accounting, personalized marketing campaigns, customer rewards, employee scheduling based on availability, shipment processing including invoice parsing and vendor communication, real-time employee productivity reporting, and proactive inventory restocking based on sales trends. The team is building toward fully autonomous store management where agents make operational decisions based on store data with minimal human input.



Customer Journey

A store owner is paying for multiple software subscriptions or frustrated with their current POS, spending hours each week manually managing inventory, shipments, scheduling, and accounting. They sign up for Swftly, migrate their existing data, and immediately begin saving time. Shipments no longer require manual data entry, scheduling runs automatically, accounting reconciles in the background, marketing campaigns launch based on real sales data promoting new products and moving slow inventory. The owner gets data-driven reports, works fewer hours, and reduces the number of employee shifts needed to keep the store running.

What Measurable Outcomes Improve?

MEASURABLE OUTCOMES — TIME LOST WITHOUT SWFTLY		
TASK	TIME LOST (WITHOUT SWFTLY)	SOURCE
Scheduling	5-10 hrs/week per manager	XShift AI, 2025 ¹¹
Accounting & Bookkeeping	20+ hrs/month	SCORE via HBK, 2025 ¹²
Shipment Processing	Hours per delivery — receiving, pricing, reconciling, and updating POS manually	Shopify ¹³
Inventory Management	Automation reduces time spent by up to 70%	Ecorn Agency, 2025 ¹⁴
Dead Stock & Stockouts	Poor inventory management costs businesses up to 11% of annual revenue	Beancount, 2026 ¹⁵

What makes Swftly 10x better?

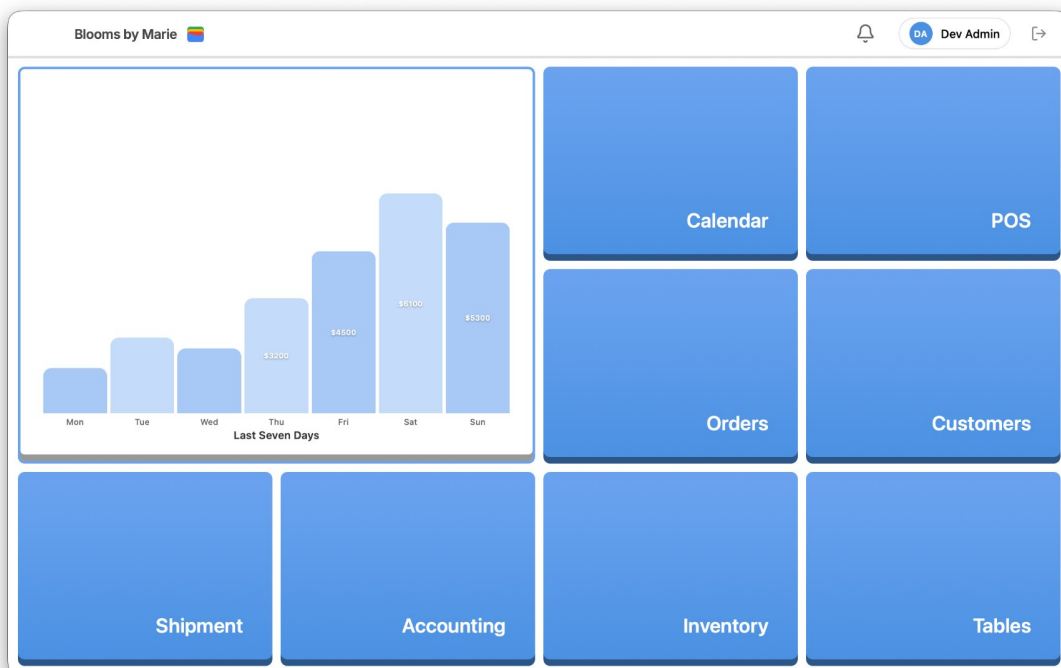
At a conservative estimate of 10 hours saved per week at \$20/hour, Swftly returns \$10,400 in recovered owner time annually against a \$420/year subscription. That's a 24x ROI before accounting for reduced labor costs, fewer missed restocks, automated marketing campaigns driving additional revenue, and the elimination of multiple software subscriptions. But the deeper advantage is structural: Swftly is not just automating tasks — Swftly is building infrastructure for agents to make decisions based on real store data and execute them with

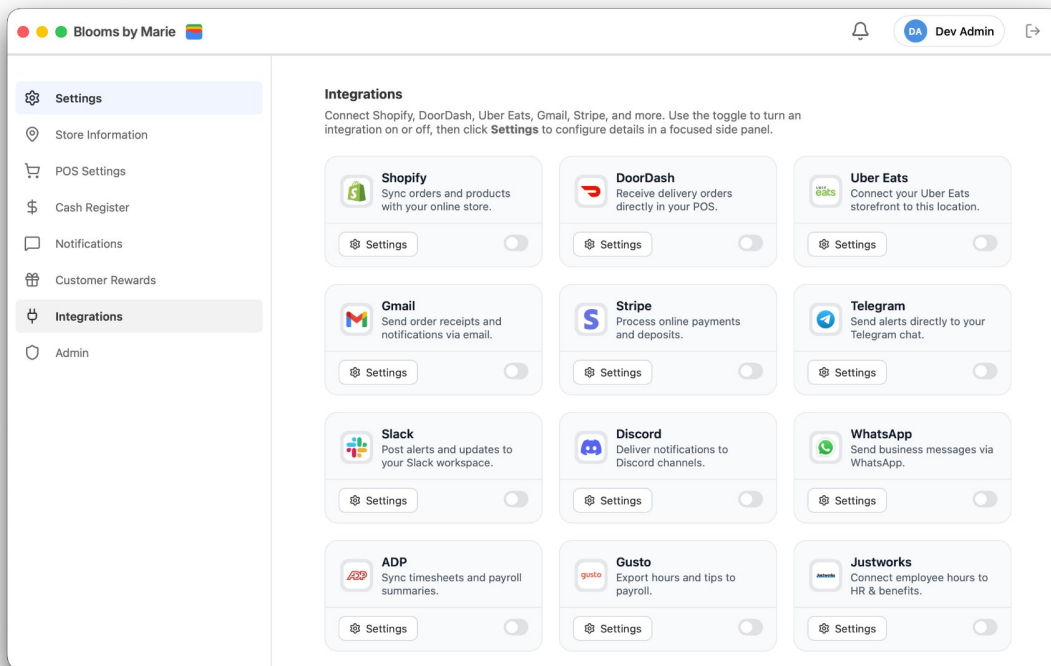


minimal human input. Owners and managers communicate with Swftly like it's their own employee. They choose their preferred level of control, receive proactive reports and alerts, and weigh in only on executive decisions. The store runs itself.

What proof do we have?

Swftly is entering Beta, it's tested, and demo-ready. The team's first case study with Blooms by Marie launches this April.





What is your current technical readiness level?

Both co-founders are technical. Daniel Lopez leads all engineering with experience working at the Stony Brook University Information Technology department. Daniel Budnyatsky contributes technically as an integration and systems architect.

What are the regulatory risks?

Swiftly operates as a software layer on top of compliant payment processors, which mitigates the most significant financial regulatory exposure. Primary risks include PCI DSS compliance obligations tied to credit card data handling, CCPA data privacy requirements governing merchant and customer information stored on the platform, and labor law variability across states that automated scheduling features must account for. Swiftly does not hold or transmit funds directly, reducing the risk of money transmission licensing requirements.

What dependencies could delay launch?



Dependencies that could delay launch include App Store approval timeline and DoorDash/Uber Eats developer program acceptance for native integrations, neither of which blocks the core product from launching.

Competitive Landscape

Who else is solving this?

Square, Clover, and Toast are the leading POS platforms in the industry.

Why do customers choose them?

Store owners primarily adopt a POS to accept credit card payments, and Square, Clover, and Toast are the biggest names because they are trustworthy, easy to find, and easy to get started with. Switching costs and hardware investment keep most stores locked in even as their needs grow beyond basic payment processing.¹⁶

What is our wedge?

Swiftly's wedge is pricing and consolidation. Swiftly brings together everything a store currently pays multiple providers for — POS, inventory management, accounting, scheduling, and marketing — all into one affordable plan, while undercutting competitors on price.

What would stop a competitor from copying us?

Autonomous store management is inevitable. Swiftly's competitors will eventually build similar features. However, introducing true agentic capabilities on top of legacy architecture takes significant time, and Square and Toast's higher cost structures make it extremely difficult to compete with our \$35 monthly price point.

What is our unfair advantage?

Swiftly's pricing model and unique features are its competitive advantage. The platform undercuts the main competitors and its inventory management automation feature is unique



and not replicated anywhere. Stores spend hours each week migrating new shipments into their system, while Swftly just requires a business to upload a shipment invoice and the platform does the rest itself. The document is intelligently parsed, prices are updated, existing items are restocked, new products are created, invoice issues are flagged, and vendors are contacted on the business's behalf to resolve them. Because all product and sales data flows through the POS, Swftly tracks expiring goods, notices trends, and anticipates restocks before a store runs out. Swftly also identifies slow-moving inventory and plans marketing campaigns to promote it. Scheduling, accounting, POS, and marketing — all in one affordable plan.

TRADITIONAL STACK	ALL-IN-ONE										
Square + add-ons	Swftly										
\$49-149	\$35										
POS only — plus required subscriptions below	Everything included — no hardware required										
<table> <tr> <td>Square POS</td><td>\$49-\$149/mo</td></tr> <tr> <td>QuickBooks</td><td>\$35-\$99/mo</td></tr> <tr> <td>Scheduling / time clock</td><td>\$20-\$60/mo</td></tr> <tr> <td>Marketing / CRM agency</td><td>\$200-\$500/mo</td></tr> <tr> <td>Hardware (required)</td><td>\$299-\$799 upfront</td></tr> </table>	Square POS	\$49-\$149/mo	QuickBooks	\$35-\$99/mo	Scheduling / time clock	\$20-\$60/mo	Marketing / CRM agency	\$200-\$500/mo	Hardware (required)	\$299-\$799 upfront	✓ POS + payments built in ✓ Automated accounting (no QuickBooks needed) ✓ Intelligent scheduling + time clock ✓ Built-in marketing + customer rewards ✓ Real-time data trends + business reports ✓ Automated shipments + vendor communication ✓ No hardware purchase required
Square POS	\$49-\$149/mo										
QuickBooks	\$35-\$99/mo										
Scheduling / time clock	\$20-\$60/mo										
Marketing / CRM agency	\$200-\$500/mo										
Hardware (required)	\$299-\$799 upfront										
Total / mo (excl. hardware) \$304-\$808	Total / mo \$35										

Average monthly savings	Average time saved per week
\$269-\$773/mo	~13-20 hrs/week

TIME SAVED BREAKDOWN — TRADITIONAL STACK VS. SWFTLY	
Accounting & invoicing	~5 hrs/wk (SCORE)
Marketing & social media	~4-6 hrs/wk (Vertical Response)
Shipment processing & vendor comms	~1-6 hrs/wk (Stamps.com, 2025)
Scheduling & time clock management	~2-3 hrs/wk
Total saved with Swftly	~13-20 hrs/week

Sources: SCORE (20+ hrs/mo on accounting & invoicing); Vertical Response survey (43% of owners spend 6 hrs/wk on social media); Stamps.com August 2025 survey of 200 business owners (50% spend 1-2 hrs/wk on shipping, 50% spend up to 6+ hrs/wk, 68% regularly interrupt work for mailing tasks).



Business Model

Independent store owners pay Swftly a flat \$35/month subscription, billed at the start of each period. Transaction fees are configured on the client side based on their choice of credit card terminal. At this price point, we operate at 20% gross margin at a single store, with fixed infrastructure costs undistributed. By 10 stores, the team will reach 51% gross margin as their \$63/month in fixed costs are spread across the base, and margins continue improving to 61% at 1,000 stores.

The team's current CAC is effectively \$0, driven entirely by cold outreach and organic content — payback is immediate. With paid ads and organic content we estimate CAC at \$20–\$80 per store through highly targeted Facebook and Instagram campaigns to local small business owners, recovering in under 2 months.

POS systems carry some of the highest switching costs in SMB software. Migrating data, retraining staff, and disrupting daily operations makes churn structurally low. At a conservative 85% annual retention rate, average customer lifetime is 6+ years, putting LTV at approximately \$2,700 per business.¹⁷

If pricing dropped 20% to \$28/month, the business would still break even at approximately 6 customers and remain profitable beyond that, reaching 52% gross margin at 1,000 clients, compared to 61% at current pricing. Swftly's \$35 price point is already the most aggressive in the POS market.

Go-To-Market Strategy

What is your first beachhead market?

The founding team's first beachhead market is brick-and-mortar small businesses in New York state, starting in Albany, NY with Blooms by Marie as the anchor case study, and expanding from New York City to Syracuse, NY.



Who is the decision maker?

The decision maker is the business owner. In businesses with 1–10 employees, there is no procurement layer.

Sales Cycle

After a client learns about Swftly's software through cold outreach, the client books a demo or the team sends over their demo, and the client can sign up on Swftly's website and independently complete onboarding in no more than an hour, as the team supports seamless migration from existing POS softwares.

Conversion Rate

Around 25% of the cold calls the team has made to business owners have been successful and resulted in them signing up for the waitlist.

What partnerships accelerate adoption?

Partnerships that accelerate adoption include social proof from Swftly's case study partners, which the founders will leverage through content and social media; native integrations with DoorDash and Uber Eats upon acceptance into their developer program; and building relationships with local business associations in Syracuse, New York City, and Long Island as warm referrals.

What defines product-market fit?

Product-market fit is defined when Swftly's successful case studies convert to paying customers. Because the founders are conducting structured studies measuring hours spent on tasks before and after Swftly, they will have concrete proof of time saved and real usage data, creating verifiable, referenceable evidence that the product delivers measurable value.

How would we acquire 100 customers in 6 months?

The founding team would complete 3–5 case studies with documented, quantified results and use them as the foundation for everything that follows. The team already has 47 people on the waitlist and has cold called 200+ businesses, with 50+ calls going out per week. The team would start converting that pipeline directly: increase calls to businesses, launch targeted Facebook and Instagram ads to small business owners in the New York City area, and leverage case study results in organic content on social media.

Traction

Swftly is pre-revenue with Blooms by Marie confirmed as the first case study launching this April. The team is currently in conversations with 3 additional stores to join the program. Swftly has 47 customers on the waitlist and the team is actively cold calling 50+ businesses per week, interviewing store owners and managers to understand their pain points and guide product development, while building a qualified pipeline ahead of public launch. The metric that matters most right now is case study success: a verified, referenceable store running on Swftly end-to-end.

Operations

Who builds the product?

Daniel Lopez is the lead engineer who designed and built Swftly's full system architecture, machine learning design that powers agentic features, and the user interface. Daniel Budnyatsky built out Swftly's accounting system to IRS compliance standards and built integrations with third-party platforms including QuickBooks, Shopify, Uber Eats, and DoorDash.

Who delivers the service?



Swiftly is self-serve. Store owners can sign up directly from Swiftly's website, complete onboarding independently, and download the app with no sales call required. Daniel Budnyatsky leads assisted onboarding for the team's case study partners.

Bottlenecks

The primary bottleneck is bandwidth as both founders are full-time students. While Swiftly onboarding is fully self-serve with a user-friendly UX, comprehensive docs, and video tutorials, growing demand for customer support is anticipated as the platform scales. As two co-founders balancing academics, there will be a point where the team needs to either leave school to commit full-time or bring on a customer support lead to absorb that load.

What happens if demand doubles?

Cloud infrastructure scales automatically. The only constraint is customer support bandwidth, which the founders address by building out Swiftly docs, tutorials, and AI customer support agents, and by hiring their first support rep in Year 1 and expanding the team in Year 2.

What risks could shut us down?

App Store rejection blocking mobile distribution and a critical data breach are the founding team's two most serious existential risks. The team has mitigated this through a web-first architecture that keeps Swiftly fully functional without the need for a native app while awaiting approval, and through meticulous system design reviewed with technical advisor Dr. Fodor, a Computer Science Professor at Stony Brook University.

What compliance requirements exist?

Compliance requirements include IRS compliance for accounting features, PCI DSS for payment processing via Stripe Connect, App Store policy compliance for mobile distribution, and data privacy compliance (CCPA/GDPR) for all store and customer data the team handles.

Development Roadmap (3 Years)



Year 1 — by end of 2026

- Complete 3–5 case studies with partner stores (April–June)
- Public launch with full agentic capabilities and customer support funnel (July)
- 50 paying customers by December
- Continuously gather usage data and client feedback to drive product iteration
- Bring on first customer support hire

Year 2 — 2027

- Scale to 200–500 paying customers
- Apply to top accelerators and pursue pre-seed funding round
- Bring on a CMO and expand marketing capacity
- Hire a second engineer
- Begin training proprietary models on real store data to improve agentic features
- Deploy AI voice agents to handle inbound customer phone calls
- Integrate security camera feeds for foot traffic analysis and shoplifting detection
- Milestone: \$100,000+ ARR

Year 3 — 2028

- 1,000+ paying customers
- Hire third engineer and expand customer support team
- Launch multi-location business management
- Introduce enterprise tier for chains and franchises
- Pursue seed funding round
- Milestone: \$420,000+ ARR

Critical Hires

1. Customer Support
2. Second Engineer



3. CMO

Financial Plan

Revenue Assumptions

Swiftly charges a flat \$35/month per store with no transaction fees or revenue share. Pricing is intentionally aggressive to undercut incumbents like Square and Toast and accelerate adoption.

REVENUE PROJECTIONS

Metric	1 Store	10 Stores	50 Stores	100 Stores	1,000 Stores
Price / store / mo	\$35	\$35	\$35	\$35	\$35
Monthly revenue	\$35	\$350	\$1,750	\$3,500	\$35,000
Annual revenue	\$420	\$4,200	\$21,000	\$42,000	\$420,000

FIXED COSTS (MONTHLY)

Item	Cost	Notes
Claude Code	\$40.00	Dev tooling, flat
Vercel	\$15.00	Website hosting, flat
Apple Developer	\$8.25	One app, all stores
Total fixed / mo	\$63.25	

VARIABLE COSTS (PER STORE / MONTH)

Item	Cost	Notes
Neon (database)	~\$2.50-\$8	Scales with store data
AWS SNS (SMS)	~\$4.00	500+ msgs @ \$0.0079
AWS SES (email)	~\$0.05	500+ emails @ \$0.10/1k
Claude API - shipments	~\$1.50	~50 shipments @ \$0.03
Claude API - agents & chatbot	~\$5.50	Vendor comms, trends, campaigns, Slack + app
Total variable / store	~\$14-\$20	

UNIT ECONOMICS BY STORE COUNT

Cost Item	1	10	50	100	1,000
Neon (database)	\$7	\$50	\$200	\$350	\$2,500
AWS SES (email)	\$0.05	\$0.50	\$2.50	\$5	\$50
AWS SNS (SMS)	\$4	\$40	\$200	\$400	\$4,000
Claude API (shipments)	\$1.50	\$15	\$75	\$150	\$1,500
Claude API (agents + chatbot)	\$5.50	\$55	\$275	\$550	\$5,500
Apple Dev (flat)	\$8.25	\$8.25	\$8.25	\$8.25	\$8.25
Vercel (flat)	\$1.67	\$1.67	\$1.67	\$1.67	\$1.67
Total cost / mo	~\$28	~\$170	~\$762	~\$1,465	~\$13,560
Cost per store	\$28	\$17	\$15.24	\$14.65	\$13.56
Revenue / mo	\$35	\$350	\$1,750	\$3,500	\$35,000
Gross margin	20%	51%	56%	58%	61%
Profit / mo	\$7	\$180	\$988	\$2,035	\$21,440

Monthly Burn (Pre-Revenue)



~\$63/month. Swftly is fully bootstrapped with no salaries drawn and no paid marketing. Growth is driven entirely through cold outreach and organic UGC, creating an effectively indefinite runway pre-launch.

Break-Even

At \$35/month per store with ~\$14–\$20 in variable costs, the founding team needs just 2 stores to cover all fixed and variable costs. Gross margins reach 58% at 100 stores and 61% at 1,000 stores, with profit of \$21,440/month at scale.

Cash Shortfall Scenario

If the grant is not awarded and case studies take longer than expected to convert to paying customers, the team would delay starting paid marketing entirely and double down on cold outreach and organic content creation until profitability is reached. Given the ~\$63/month burn rate, Swftly's cost structure remains sustainable.

Contingency

The team's primary contingency is the cost structure at ~\$63/month in fixed costs, with which they can operate indefinitely without external funding. If a client backs out of the case study, the team is consistently getting new leads from market research.

Team

Daniel Budnyatsky — Co-Founder & Business Developer

Daniel Budnyatsky is studying accounting at Syracuse University and worked at Licensed To Count Inc., an accounting firm that works with small businesses. Budnyatsky leads the development of Swftly's accounting systems, credit card processing infrastructure, and merchant terminal integrations. He built the integrations between Swftly and third-party platforms including QuickBooks, Shopify, Uber Eats, and DoorDash, and ensures compatibility across all major credit card processing terminals. Beyond the product,



Budnyatsky drives Swftly's client acquisition strategy, leveraging direct outreach and targeted marketing to build and grow the platform's customer base.

Daniel Lopez — Co-Founder & Lead Developer

Daniel Lopez is studying Computer Science at Stony Brook University and has 4 years of experience working with Swftly's competitor software at different businesses in a cashier and stocker role. Lopez leads software development with a focus on system design and machine learning, using data collected at checkout to automate the operational tasks required to run a store. Lopez is proficient in Python and Java with experience as a freelance web developer.

Indaria Jones — Business Advisor

Business Development Advisor at the Couri Hatchery Student Business Incubator, Whitman School of Management.

Paul Fodor — Technical Advisor

PhD, Professor of Computer Science at Stony Brook University. Dr. Fodor advises on systems architecture and scalability.

What skills are missing?

The team is missing a full-time CMO and a customer support team. Currently, Daniel Lopez works entirely on product development; Daniel Budnyatsky splits his time between product development, market research, client acquisition, and marketing. The team plans to build out a full AI customer support team before launch to reduce the amount of human support required.

If one founder left

The business is dependent on both founders. If Daniel Lopez left, software development would stop and would require bringing on a new founding engineer. If Daniel Budnyatsky left, the team would lose crucial oversight of the accounting software and all market research and client acquisition would stop.



Prior Venture

Prior to Swftly, the founding team ran a residential window cleaning business together, acquiring 15 clients entirely through door-to-door sales in just 2 months. The team managed customer relationships and delivered quality service end-to-end.

Funding & Ask

~\$10,000

What this unlocks

Both co-founders come from working-class families. Raising \$10K would allow them to work full-time and perfect the platform over the summer without needing to accept paid internships, keeping their full focus on Swftly. Funds would be allocated toward cloud infrastructure, App Store deployment costs, higher usage of Claude Code subscriptions to accelerate development, paid ads, and running the first 3–5 case studies at zero cost to partner businesses.

Runway

8–10 months of full operational and development coverage through the case study phase and into Swftly's launch and initial revenue generation.

If we only raise half

One co-founder accepts a paid internship and contributes part-time. The team would reduce their marketing budget and redirect remaining funds toward cloud infrastructure and core development.

Exit Pathway

Swftly's exit pathways are a pre-seed raise or acquisition by an existing POS provider. As the team completes their case studies and demonstrates early revenue, they plan to apply to accelerators and pre-seed funds to accelerate growth.



Risks & Mitigation

Biggest reason this could fail

The biggest reason this could fail is not scaling the team fast enough while managing academic commitments. The team's first case study with Blooms by Marie represents a significant responsibility — Swftly would handle their entire store operations and transactions. The founders are fully prepared for their initial case study, but as they bring on additional clients, they will need to scale rapidly to support any potential software-related issues that could arise. Through development, the team has prioritized system design. The founders have developed the ability for Swftly to run locally to mitigate the risk of unforeseen server outages, but recognize that scaling a customer support and engineering team is critical to Swftly's long-term growth and sustainability.

Most fragile assumption

The biggest assumption is that store owners are willing to switch. The founding team is actively conducting market research, speaking with store owners daily. The friction point is migration — owners may be hesitant to adopt new software and retrain their staff. To address this, the team built out seamless data migration from QuickBooks and Square, and are expanding support to additional POS providers, while continuously improving UX based on user feedback.

External factors that could disrupt growth

Apple has significantly tightened its App Store review policies, which could delay Swftly's mobile app submission. While Swftly is not dependent on a native mobile app, it drastically improves security and user experience compared to web-based use on mobile. Additionally, native integrations with DoorDash and Uber Eats may take longer than anticipated, but the founders are currently in the application process with both platforms.



What we are doing now to reduce risk

Swiftly's leadership is launching with a focused beta group of 3–5 committed stores to run a structured case study, generating real feedback from users and collecting data from the software to understand usage trends, surface bugs, and identify missing features. Additionally, the team is cold calling 50+ businesses per week to interview managers and store owners about their current software stack, pain points with existing POS systems, time spent on weekly operational tasks, and feedback on Swiftly. This ensures the founders are building directly in response to client needs.



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